



Strong Objection to the New Sankeshwar-Parknatti Survey for Belagavi-Kolhapur Railway Line and Urgent Request for Approval of Karad-Ichalkaranji-Nipani-Belagavi (191 km) Route

3 messages

Vicky Lokare <newwaynewdreams@gmail.com> Sun, 7 Jun, 2026 at 5:08 pm
To: Shri. Devendra Fadnavis (Chief Minister) <CM@maharashtra.gov.in>, chiefminister@maharashtra.gov.in, contact@devendrafadnavis.in, devendrafadnavis@yahoo.com, hm@mha.gov.in, officeofmr@gov.in, railmadad@gov.in, mlaprakashabitkar@gmail.com, collector.kolhapur@maharashtra.gov.in, addcoll.kolhapur@maharashtra.gov.in, srini@monarchpune.in, compliance@monarchpune.in, connect@mygov.nic.in
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To,
The Chairman,
Railway Board,
New Delhi - 110001

Copy to:
- Hon'ble Prime Minister of India, Shri Narendra Modi Ji
- Hon'ble Minister of Railways, Government of India
- Hon'ble Chief Minister, Maharashtra State, Shri Devendra Fadnavis Ji
- General Manager, Pune Railway Division, Pune
- Hon'ble Member of Parliament, Hatkanangle Lok Sabha Constituency
- Hon'ble MLAs, Ichalkaranji / Hatkanangle / Karad / Walwa

Respected Sir,

We, the Ichalkaranji Railway Action Committee, on behalf of citizens, industrialists, traders, farmers, Ichalkaranji and surrounding areas, hereby register our strong objection to the newly commenced survey for the Belagavi-Kolhapur railway line via Sankeshwar-Parknatti.

Ichalkaranji, known as the "Manchester of Maharashtra", is a major textile hub and an emerging centre for modern industries. Despite this, the region still lacks direct rail connectivity, which is severely affecting industrial growth, freight movement, employment generation, and passenger convenience.

Key Facts:

- The detailed survey of the Karad-Ichalkaranji-Nipani-Belagavi Broad Gauge Railway line (191 km, estimated cost ₹2,100 crore) has already been completed.
- Smt. Mangaladevi Shinde, President of Aastha Municipal Council, has also demanded immediate approval of this project.
- This alignment was found technically viable in the 2012 Central Railway survey.

Major Benefits of the Karad-Ichalkaranji-Nipani-Belagavi Route:

1. Saves approx. 20 km distance and 1 to 1.5 hours travel time by bypassing the Miraj loop.
2. Provides direct rail connectivity to textile, engineering, agro-based industries.
3. Ensures faster market access for agricultural produce from fertile lands.
4. Strengthens the Pune-Bengaluru Economic Corridor and promotes inter-state trade between Maharashtra and Karnataka.
5. More cost-effective as the Hatkanangle-Ichalkaranji (8 km) section can be easily integrated, creating a junction at Ichalkaranji.

Strong Objection:

As reported in recent newspapers, a fresh survey for the Belagavi-Kolhapur railway line has been started via Sankeshwar-Parknatti. We strongly object to this sudden change of alignment when a complete and viable survey via Ichalkaranji already exists.

This new alignment bypasses a major industrial centre (Ichalkaranji) and passes through highly fertile agricultural land, which will cause substantial loss to farmers. Such a decision is against public interest, industrial development, and regional growth.

We unequivocally state that any railway route bypassing Ichalkaranji is completely unacceptable to the people of this region.

Our Demands:

1. Immediately grant administrative approval to the already surveyed Karad-Ichalkaranji-Nipani-Belagavi (191 km) Broad Gauge Railway line.
2. Link the Hatkanangle-Ichalkaranji (8 km) section with the main route.
3. Allocate necessary funds in the upcoming Union Budget 2026-27.

4. Stop the ongoing Sankeshwar-Parknatti survey forthwith.
5. Call an urgent joint meeting at Pune Railway Division with our representatives, local MPs/MLAs, and Railway officials.

We are fully prepared to submit all relevant documents, maps, and survey reports during the meeting.

We request you to treat this matter as one of urgent public importance and take immediate favourable action.

Thanking you,

Yours sincerely,

Ichalkaranji Railway Action Committee.

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